

## film review

### Not that Magical

**THODA PYAAR THODA MAGIC**

Director: Kunal Kohli

Starring: Rani Mukerji, Saif Ali Khan

Anyone who thinks children want to watch an angel doesn't know them well enough. They love the little cruelties of life and thrive on total anarchy. What they adore is the edgy undertones of *Nanny McPhee*, its quite hideous little children who make life hell for nannies and daddy's prospective wives, and its somewhat sinister Emma Thompson whose magical powers seem borrowed from the dark side. But Kunal Kohli doesn't get it. His children are never monstrous enough and his angel is Miss Goody-Two-Shoes dipped in honey. Anyone



#### ALL FOR LOVE: A still from the film

familiar with Roald Dahl's popular books—or even the film based on his book, *Matilda*—will know what children really really like are the horrible bits. In *Thoda Pyaar Thoda Magic*, they are few and far in between, with the children unleashing disappointingly tame humiliations on the object of their attrition, Ranbir Talwar (a buttoned-up Saif Ali Khan, with suspiciously beautifully curled eyelashes) who has accidentally killed their parents in a car crash and

the angel Gita (Mukerji) not being able to make her ever-perky angel naughty enough. A tedious love angle is introduced which requires the angel to cry like a human and the movie's high point, a delightfully ditsy Amisha Patel playing a society airhead, is given short shrift. Sigh! Just when her *Lazy lamhe*, yellow bikini and underwater acrobatics had arrested our attention. *Bahut thoda pyaar* and *bahut thoda magic*.

by Kaveree Bamzai

## music reviews

### Soulful Rendition



Sa Re Ga Ma  
Rs 250

**ASHA BHOSLE**  
Bollywood music would not have been what it is today

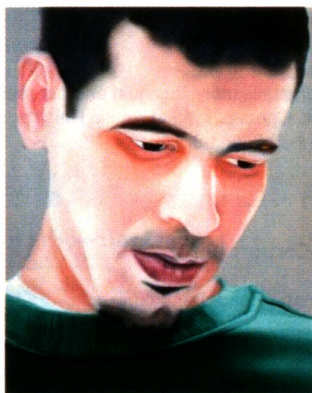
without the voice of the versatile Asha Bhosle. The ageless diva stared her career way back in 1943 and today, after nearly 65 impeccable years in the music industry, she is still going strong. Bhosle, has lent her charming voice to several bhajans, qawwalis, pop songs and ghazals, all with equal élan. *Asha Bhosle*, the twin album set, features all her '70s hits, be it *Dum maro dum* (Hare Rama Hare Krishna), or *Tum bhi chalo* (Zameer), *Tauba tauba kya hoga* (Mr Natwarlal) or *O saathi re* (Muqaddar ka Sikandar). All her songs have an individual style and tenor. That is what makes them immortal.

## recommendations

### Creative Connect

**MUMBAI** The novelty of this exhibition lies in the choice of artists. Sakshi Gallery's Link is a collection of 20 works of art by 11 artists including Reji Arakkal, Sunil Gawde, Subodh Gupta, Riyas Komu and Mithu Sen. The collection exposes the audience to internationally popular artists and also gives aficionados an idea of the kind of art that is relevant globally. "Link connects artists whose work is popular in the international arena. Such a group show is a rare event," explains Manju Sara Rajan, spokesperson for the Gallery. The exhibition is on display till July 15.

by Swati Mathur



#### A work on display

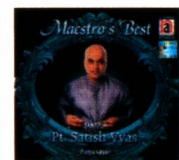
NATASHA HEMRAJANI



#### A scene from Wedding Album

**BANGALORE** Girish Karnad's latest play *Wedding Album*, written in Konkani and translated into English, deals with the universal institution of marriage. Karnad brings to stage a comic drama that deals with a very unique Indian situation. Directed by Lillete Dubey, the play had a good initial run in Mumbai and is brought to Bangalore by India Foundation for the Arts. With an impressive star cast comprising film and television personalities, the play hopes to recreate its successful run in Karnad's hometown. Set in a typical south Indian middle-class home, it has characters with complexities that are hidden in their simple everyday lives.

by Nirmala Ravindran



NA Classical  
Rs 195

**MAESTRO'S BEST**  
At a time when most musicians play only some parts

of a raga at concerts and the audience is left craving for more, santoor maestro Satish Vyas has more to offer. He presents an evening raga Puriya Kalyan, which will enthral the audience for complete 60 minutes. Vyas has formidable musical background and training—thanks to his father-guru Pandit C.R. Vyas and Pandit Shiv Kumar Sharma, who taught him how to create magic with the strings of santoor. Vyas, however, has tried to follow his own style of mastering the instrument, which is unique and melodious in its own way.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit